

UNOFFICIAL FAN GUIDE

2026 SEASON GUIDE

Race Calendar & Key Dates

A Beginner's Guide to the Formula 1 Season

Pre-Season Testing

Three rounds of official pre-season testing take place before the first Grand Prix, giving teams their first chance to run the revolutionary 2026 cars on track.

Test	Circuit	Location	Dates
Test 1	Circuit de Barcelona-Catalunya	Barcelona, Spain	Jan 26 - 30
Test 2	Bahrain International Circuit	Sakhir, Bahrain	Feb 11 - 13
Test 3	Bahrain International Circuit	Sakhir, Bahrain	Feb 18 - 20

Testing Format

Each test day runs two 4-hour sessions (morning and afternoon). All 11 teams participate simultaneously. Tire testing for Pirelli is integrated into the schedule.

2026 Race Calendar

The 2026 season features 24 Grands Prix across five continents. Six weekends feature the Sprint format (marked with * below).

24

Grands Prix

6

Sprints

21

Countries

5

Continents



2026 Season Overview: 24 races from March to December

Rd	Grand Prix	Circuit	Location	Date	Format
1	Australian Grand Prix	Albert Park	Melbourne, Australia	Mar 8	
2	Chinese Grand Prix*	Shanghai Int'l Circuit	Shanghai, China	Mar 15	Sprint
3	Japanese Grand Prix	Suzuka Circuit	Suzuka, Japan	Mar 29	

Rd	Grand Prix	Circuit	Location	Date	Format
4	Bahrain Grand Prix	Bahrain Int'l Circuit	Sakhir, Bahrain	Apr 12	
5	Saudi Arabian Grand Prix	Jeddah Corniche Circuit	Jeddah, Saudi Arabia	Apr 19	
6	Miami Grand Prix*	Miami Int'l Autodrome	Miami, USA	May 3	Sprint
7	Canadian Grand Prix*	Circuit Gilles Villeneuve	Montreal, Canada	May 24	Sprint
8	Monaco Grand Prix	Circuit de Monaco	Monte Carlo, Monaco	Jun 7	
9	Spanish Grand Prix	Circuit de Barcelona-Catalunya	Barcelona, Spain	Jun 14	
10	Austrian Grand Prix	Red Bull Ring	Spielberg, Austria	Jun 28	
11	British Grand Prix*	Silverstone Circuit	Silverstone, UK	Jul 5	Sprint
12	Belgian Grand Prix	Spa-Francorchamps	Stavelot, Belgium	Jul 19	
13	Hungarian Grand Prix	Hungaroring	Budapest, Hungary	Jul 26	
--	SUMMER BREAK			Aug 3-22	
14	Dutch Grand Prix*	Circuit Zandvoort	Zandvoort, Netherlands	Aug 23	Sprint
15	Italian Grand Prix	Autodromo di Monza	Monza, Italy	Sep 6	
16	Madrid Grand Prix	Madrid Circuit	Madrid, Spain	Sep 13	
17	Azerbaijan Grand Prix	Baku City Circuit	Baku, Azerbaijan	Sep 26	
18	Singapore Grand Prix*	Marina Bay Street Circuit	Singapore	Oct 11	Sprint
19	United States Grand Prix	Circuit of the Americas	Austin, USA	Oct 25	
20	Mexican Grand Prix	Autodromo H. Rodriguez	Mexico City, Mexico	Nov 1	
21	Brazilian Grand Prix	Interlagos	Sao Paulo, Brazil	Nov 8	
22	Las Vegas Grand Prix	Las Vegas Street Circuit	Las Vegas, USA	Nov 22	
23	Qatar Grand Prix	Lusail Int'l Circuit	Lusail, Qatar	Nov 29	
24	Abu Dhabi Grand Prix	Yas Marina Circuit	Abu Dhabi, UAE	Dec 6	

How to Read the Calendar

Each Grand Prix takes place over a full weekend (Friday-Sunday). Rounds marked with * use the Sprint format, which features a shorter Sprint race on Saturday in addition to the main Grand Prix on Sunday. See the Race Weekend Format guide for full details.

Sprint Weekends

Six Grands Prix feature the Sprint format, which replaces FP2 and FP3 with Sprint Qualifying and a shorter Sprint Race on Saturday.

Rd	Grand Prix	Location	Date
2	Chinese Grand Prix	Shanghai	Mar 15
6	Miami Grand Prix	Miami	May 3
7	Canadian Grand Prix	Montreal	May 24
11	British Grand Prix	Silverstone	Jul 5
14	Dutch Grand Prix	Zandvoort	Aug 23
18	Singapore Grand Prix	Singapore	Oct 11

Key Dates & Notes

Madrid GP Debut

Round 16 marks the inaugural Madrid Grand Prix, held on a new purpose-built circuit in the Spanish capital. Madrid joins the calendar as an addition alongside Barcelona, giving Spain two Grands Prix.

Zandvoort Final Year

2026 is the final season for the Dutch Grand Prix at Zandvoort. The race has been on the calendar since its return in 2021.

Summer Break

The mandatory summer shutdown runs August 3-22. All team factories must close for a consecutive 14-day period within this window.

Season Span

The 2026 season runs from March 8 to December 6 - a 39-week season covering 24 races across 21 countries on 5 continents.